

Working well with difference.

What Australian workplace culture has taught me
about communication, inclusion and equal opportunity.

Zizhen Liu • Individual presentation

The same message can be understood in different ways.

01 • CULTURE

Direct and indirect feedback

In multicultural group work, I noticed that direct Australian feedback can sound strong to someone used to a more indirect style. I learned to check the intention before reacting.

02 • LANGUAGE

Accent and speaking speed

Fast speech, local expressions and different accents can cause misunderstandings. A short written summary helps everyone confirm the same meaning.

Diversity improves ideas and decisions — **when people can participate fully.**



Better ideas: different experience reveals risks and opportunities others may miss.



Stronger service: a diverse team understands a wider range of customers.



Possible friction: stereotypes, unclear language or exclusion can reduce trust.

Fair treatment is more than good manners — it is protected by law.

2009

Fair Work Act

Employers cannot take adverse action because of protected attributes such as race, sex, age, disability or religion.

1975

Racial Discrimination Act

Protects people from unfair treatment because of race, colour, descent, or national or ethnic origin.

1984

Sex Discrimination Act

Protects against sex discrimination and sexual harassment, and covers attributes including sexual orientation and gender identity.

Sources: [Fair Work Ombudsman](#) · [Australian Human Rights Commission](#)

Inclusion is built through **daily behaviour.**

AUSTRALIA

Open and formal

Equal opportunity is discussed openly, first names are common, and formal complaint pathways are visible.

CHINA

More hierarchical

Communication can be more indirect, and raising concerns with a senior person may feel more sensitive.

My practical response

- Ask instead of assuming.
- Use plain language and written follow-ups.
- Invite quieter people to contribute.
- Speak up early and use the correct process.

These are personal observations, not rules about every person or workplace.